Denmark: energy security, economic opportunity and partnership priorities

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AI-generated from the data and checked against it; paper baseline as of 12 October 2026.

Summary

- Denmark is most exposed in downstream gas, upstream nuclear and downstream coal, where its Energy Security is higher than only 2%, 7% and 8% of the other economies scored. In both downstream sectors, low and falling consumption per person pulls the score down.[1]
- Its strongest openings are in midstream wind, midstream oil and midstream nuclear, where its Economic Opportunity is higher than 94%, 92% and 91% of the other economies scored.[1]
- On the paper's weighting, the Strategic Index ranks upstream nuclear 1st among Denmark's own sectors, with security need its largest part; policy activity there sits in the middle group.[1]
- The Partnership Strength Index rates Sweden highest for Denmark, above all as an export market, and it is also Denmark's 1st trade partner. China, its 7th trade partner, ranks 44th on Partnership Strength.[1,2]

1. Energy security risks and why

12 of Denmark's 30 placed sectors, those where both scores can be compared with other economies, sit in the two low-energy-security corners. Energy Security measures how well a country can rely on what it needs. Compared with other economies, its Energy Security is lowest in downstream gas (0.33), upstream nuclear (0.16) and downstream coal (0.37), all in the Secure corner. These scores are higher than only 2%, 7% and 8% of the other 98, 174 and 98 economies scored in each sector.[1]

In downstream gas and downstream coal, the score is low mainly because of energy access, which the index reads from consumption per person and its change. Gas consumption was 9.54 GJ per person in 2025, after a change of -33.2%; for coal the figures were 1.3 GJ per person and -77.4%. In upstream nuclear, the trade category pulls the score down: Denmark's share of world exports of these goods was 0.0% in 2023.[3,4]

Country Insights takes its high-priority sectors from the Upgrade corner, which pairs high opportunity with low energy security, in Strategic Index order: midstream solar, downstream solar and upstream coal. On Energy Security, midstream solar scores 0.34 and downstream solar 0.45. In midstream solar, foreign dependency pulls the score down: the announced share of world manufacturing capacity for 2035 is 0.0%, the EU's announced share, carried by each EU member. In downstream solar, the reserves category, which here measures solar resource potential, pulls it down: Denmark scores higher than only 3% of the other economies on that measure. For context, its largest suppliers in midstream solar in 2024 were Germany (17.6% of imports worth USD 3.55 bn) and China (16.3%).[1,2,5]

2. Economic opportunities and why

20 of the 30 placed sectors sit in the two high-opportunity corners, where Economic Opportunity, how well placed a country is to create value, is at or above the sector median. Compared with other economies, its Economic Opportunity is highest in midstream wind, midstream oil and midstream nuclear, all in the Grow corner. These scores are higher than 94%, 92% and 91% of the other 64, 155 and 153 economies scored.[1]

In midstream wind, the score rests mainly on foreign dependency and investment. Here, foreign dependency reads the announced share of world manufacturing capacity for 2035: 15.0%, the EU's announced share, carried by each EU member. On annual investment, Denmark scores higher than 92% of the other economies. In midstream oil and midstream nuclear, trade and cost competitiveness push the score up: exports of these goods were USD 794 m and USD 114 m in 2024.[1,5,6]

Among the high-priority sectors, downstream solar has Economic Opportunity higher than 80% of the other 147 economies scored. Cost competitiveness and energy access push it up: solar consumption was 2.69 GJ per person in 2025, after a change of 269.6%. For context, the largest markets for its midstream wind exports of USD 3.97 bn in 2024 were the United States (15.5%), France (13.3%) and Germany (12.6%).[1,2,3]

3. Sectoral priorities and the existing policy posture

The Strategic Index ranks a country's own sectors by opportunity, security need, policy activity, stage and low-emission value. On the paper's weighting, it puts upstream nuclear 1st, upstream batteries 2nd, upstream wind 3rd, midstream batteries 4th and upstream solar 5th among Denmark's own sectors. At 0.66, upstream nuclear leads by 0.015, while the others are each almost tied with the next (0.007, 0.004, just under 0.010 and 0.001 apart). Of these, upstream nuclear, upstream batteries, upstream wind and midstream batteries sit in the Secure corner, so security need lifts them: in upstream nuclear that part adds 0.252, against 0.154 for opportunity. The paper's framework associates that corner with securing supply through trusted partners.[1]

Denmark's allied pick, its top upstream or midstream sector after a screen for a recorded resource base, is midstream batteries (0.64), 0.011 ahead of midstream solar. The screen removes upstream nuclear, upstream batteries and upstream wind.[7]

Policy activity counts the International Energy Agency's Policies and Measures records and the Climate Action Tracker rating, which favours low-emission technologies over coal, oil and gas. Country Insights splits data-based priority (the Strategic Index without its policy part) and policy activity into thirds; both are high in upstream batteries, midstream batteries and midstream solar. No sector pairs high priority with the least policy; among high priorities, policy is weakest in upstream green hydrogen (3rd on priority, 18th on policy). The reverse, low priority with the most policy, applies to downstream wind. Denmark carries the Climate Action Tracker rating Insufficient (November 2024) and has 195 Policies and Measures records.[1,8,9]

4. Partnership priorities and why

The Partnership Strength Index rates partners as suppliers (Friendshore), as export markets (Partnership Opportunity) and, for middle- and lower-income partners, by Development Potential. From Denmark's viewpoint it ranks Sweden 1st, the United States 2nd, France 3rd, Germany 4th and the Netherlands 5th of 192 partners. Sweden and France score best as an export market; the best sectors for Sweden include upstream oil, midstream wind, midstream nuclear, upstream gas and midstream batteries. The United

States, Germany and the Netherlands score best as a reliable supplier; for the United States the best sectors are downstream gas, downstream solar, upstream oil, midstream batteries and upstream coal.[1]

These priorities largely match today's ties. Sweden is also Denmark's 1st trade partner on average across its energy-goods baskets, Germany its 2nd, the Netherlands its 4th, France its 6th and the United States its 8th. Each is a priority partner with strong ties today, shares membership of NATO with Denmark and sits in the same bloc in UN votes. By contrast, China is its 7th trade partner but ranks 44th on Partnership Strength, and China and Denmark sit in opposite blocs in UN votes.[1,2,10,11]

As a partner to the coalition, Denmark ranks 17th of 192 economies on Partnership Strength averaged over the core members' viewpoints. In the allied network design, which spreads production of each upstream and midstream sector across coalition members, its largest derived share is 0.5% of midstream green hydrogen.[1,7]

5. Data notes and caveats

Values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026. Scores compare Denmark with other economies in the same sector; they are not measures of risk or profit in absolute terms. All index values are the paper's baseline as of 12 October 2026; Strategic Insights recomputes them under other weightings. Strategic Index scores within 0.01 of each other are almost tied: small changes in the data or the weights can swap their order. Many allied picks are close calls: in the paper, 37% of them are within 0.01 of the runner-up. In the allied network design the European Union is one producer; Denmark's shares are derived from its weight within the EU. The Climate Action Tracker rates the EU as a whole; Denmark carries the EU's rating. Denmark's counts leave out the EU's own 438 International Energy Agency policy records. Trade figures count trade with other EU members. Each EU member carries the EU's announced 2035 manufacturing-capacity shares and electric-vehicle figures. The Country Insights page shows the data behind each figure.

Sources

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